

A Newcomer's Practical Guide to Malmö

Sample document written for RAG practice. General information only.

Getting around

Malmö is a compact city and cycling is the most popular way to get around, thanks to an extensive network of bike lanes. Buses run across the city, and regional trains connect Malmö to Lund, Helsingborg and Copenhagen. The Öresund Bridge links Sweden and Denmark, and trains cross it regularly. Travel tickets are usually bought through the regional transport operator's app.

Neighbourhoods

The city centre is close to the central station and the canals. Western Harbour is a modern district with waterfront apartments and parks. Möllevången is known for its market, restaurants and lively evenings, while areas like Limhamn and Slottsstaden offer a quieter residential feel. Renting housing in the city can be competitive, so people often register with several housing queues.

Parks and outdoors

Malmö has many green spaces, including Kungsparken, Pildammsparken and Ribersborg beach with its long promenade. Sea swimming at Ribersborg is popular in summer, and some people continue into the colder months. Dog owners can find open spaces for walks throughout the city, though local rules about leads apply.

Everyday life

Card payments are common, and many shops do not accept cash. A Swedish personal identity number, or personnummer, is used for many services, and getting one is an important step for people who plan to stay. Opening hours are generally shorter on Sundays. Recycling is well organised, and most apartment buildings have sorting rooms.

Learning Swedish

Municipalities offer Swedish for immigrants, known as SFI, free of charge to eligible residents. Many people continue with further courses in Swedish as a second language, called SVA, to reach the level needed for higher education or many jobs. Practising with neighbours, colleagues and local groups speeds up progress.